

Table 1: Table 5.2 — Pre-Announcement Run-Up: Thesis (first deal) vs. All Deals (stacked)

	Thesis (first deal)								All deals (stacked)							
	Cash				Stock				Cash				Stock			
	CshR	UncR	CshSc	HiSc	CshR	UncR	CshSc	HiSc	CshR	UncR	CshSc	HiSc	CshR	UncR	CshSc	HiSc
PreAnnounceQtr	0.0051*** (0.0017)	0.0461*** (0.0172)	0.0854 (0.0749)	0.0408** (0.0194)	-0.0036 (0.0035)	-0.0429 (0.0307)	-0.3222 (0.2024)	-0.0303 (0.0313)	0.0033** (0.0015)	0.0391*** (0.0140)	0.0082 (0.0582)	0.0184 (0.0155)	-0.0059* (0.0032)	-0.0348 (0.0272)	-0.2332 (0.1867)	-0.0006 (0.0337)
Leverage	-0.0146*** (0.0039)	-0.0338 (0.0217)	-0.1521 (0.1470)	-0.0179 (0.0308)	-0.0213*** (0.0034)	-0.0292 (0.0196)	-0.1056 (0.1358)	-0.0428 (0.0262)	-0.0142*** (0.0037)	-0.0331 (0.0221)	-0.1254 (0.1384)	-0.0194 (0.0293)	-0.0219*** (0.0034)	-0.0279 (0.0193)	-0.1159 (0.1345)	-0.0432* (0.0259)
lnAssets	-0.0072*** (0.0011)	-0.0037 (0.0082)	-0.0391 (0.0482)	0.0190** (0.0096)	-0.0079*** (0.0008)	-0.0043 (0.0063)	-0.0733** (0.0369)	0.0077 (0.0078)	-0.0072*** (0.0011)	-0.0024 (0.0079)	-0.0327 (0.0455)	0.0200** (0.0092)	-0.0079*** (0.0008)	-0.0034 (0.0062)	-0.0632* (0.0368)	0.0089 (0.0077)
TobinsQ	0.0013** (0.0006)	-0.0031 (0.0030)	-0.0208 (0.0144)	0.0006 (0.0027)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	-0.0017 (0.0025)	-0.0113 (0.0123)	0.0030 (0.0024)	0.0012** (0.0005)	-0.0028 (0.0029)	-0.0196 (0.0138)	0.0011 (0.0026)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	-0.0018 (0.0025)	-0.0133 (0.0127)	0.0031 (0.0024)
ROA	0.0053 (0.0042)	0.0499 (0.0321)	-0.5659** (0.2254)	-0.1006** (0.0405)	0.0075* (0.0041)	0.0530* (0.0296)	-0.5350*** (0.1982)	-0.0869** (0.0366)	0.0062 (0.0042)	0.0529* (0.0319)	-0.5633** (0.2190)	-0.1053*** (0.0397)	0.0067* (0.0040)	0.0579** (0.0293)	-0.5386*** (0.1952)	-0.0892** (0.0362)
Capex	-0.1057*** (0.0126)	0.0842 (0.0986)	-1.2215*** (0.3534)	-0.3646*** (0.0880)	-0.1067*** (0.0113)	0.1256 (0.1006)	-1.4479*** (0.3000)	-0.4470*** (0.0793)	-0.1044*** (0.0119)	0.1487 (0.1061)	-1.1021*** (0.3375)	-0.3503*** (0.0848)	-0.1078*** (0.0112)	0.1291 (0.0995)	-1.4815*** (0.3046)	-0.4413*** (0.0791)
DivDummy	-0.0011 (0.0009)	-0.0030 (0.0106)	-0.0561 (0.0537)	-0.0111 (0.0107)	-0.0017** (0.0008)	-0.0137* (0.0080)	-0.0564 (0.0384)	-0.0146* (0.0087)	-0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0058 (0.0101)	-0.0593 (0.0518)	-0.0128 (0.0104)	-0.0017** (0.0008)	-0.0141* (0.0079)	-0.0541 (0.0380)	-0.0141 (0.0086)
sCFO	0.0008 (0.0006)	0.0052 (0.0085)	0.1180*** (0.0140)	0.0235*** (0.0028)	0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0009 (0.0110)	0.0906*** (0.0337)	0.0169*** (0.0057)	0.0008 (0.0006)	0.0046 (0.0088)	0.1004*** (0.0313)	0.0197*** (0.0056)	0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0109)	0.0911*** (0.0334)	0.0171*** (0.0057)
Firms	2,232	1,248	1,237	1,237	2,281	1,338	1,325	1,325	2,336	1,346	1,332	1,332	2,351	1,362	1,348	1,348
N	67,590	27,622	26,216	26,216	84,979	39,377	37,065	37,065	70,820	29,325	27,825	27,825	86,372	39,965	37,599	37,599

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed); SE clustered by firm. CshR=CashRatio(+lag), UncR=UncResCEO, CshSc=CashScrutiny, HiSc=HighCashScrutiny.

Table 2: Table 5.3 — Matched Universe Event Study: Thesis vs. All Deals (stacked)

	Thesis		All deals (stacked)	
	UncRes	CashR	UncRes	CashR
PRE2	0.0068 (0.0178)	0.0008 (0.0024)	0.0052 (0.0135)	0.0003 (0.0019)
PRE1	0.0473*** (0.0178)	0.0061** (0.0024)	0.0352** (0.0148)	0.0026 (0.0021)
GAP	0.0018 (0.0187)	0.0055 (0.0034)	-0.0011 (0.0129)	0.0059** (0.0026)
POST	-0.0250* (0.0130)	-0.0155*** (0.0022)	-0.0192* (0.0105)	-0.0150*** (0.0018)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	0.0455** (0.0225)	0.0006 (0.0039)	0.0363** (0.0156)	-0.0033 (0.0029)
Drop: GAP – POST	0.0268 (0.0199)	0.0210*** (0.0042)	0.0181 (0.0123)	0.0210*** (0.0027)
Drop: PRE1 – POST	0.0723*** (0.0190)	0.0216*** (0.0031)	0.0544*** (0.0139)	0.0176*** (0.0021)
<i>Controls</i>				
Leverage	-0.0415* (0.0213)	-0.0215*** (0.0054)	-0.0302 (0.0212)	-0.0204*** (0.0049)
lnAssets	-0.0060 (0.0084)	-0.0074*** (0.0020)	-0.0005 (0.0075)	-0.0089*** (0.0018)
TobinsQ	-0.0045 (0.0029)	0.0013** (0.0006)	-0.0029 (0.0027)	0.0013** (0.0006)
ROA	0.0572* (0.0325)	0.0067 (0.0061)	0.0507 (0.0311)	0.0101* (0.0060)
Capex	0.1073 (0.1054)	-0.1434*** (0.0141)	0.1504 (0.1104)	-0.1420*** (0.0134)
DivDummy	-0.0099 (0.0104)	-0.0016 (0.0014)	-0.0128 (0.0097)	-0.0016 (0.0014)
sCFO	0.0096** (0.0043)	-0.0011 (0.0007)	0.0063 (0.0061)	-0.0010 (0.0007)
CashRatio _{t-1} (partial adj.)	—	0.7547*** (0.0108)	—	0.7596*** (0.0102)
N	28,102	28,102	31,199	31,199
Firms	1,320	1,320	1,377	1,377

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed); SE clustered by firm.

Table 3: Table 5.4 — Event Study by Payment Type (placebo): Thesis vs. All Deals (stacked)

	Thesis		All deals (stacked)	
	Cash	Stock	Cash	Stock
PRE2	0.0105 (0.0174)	-0.0056 (0.0368)	0.0100 (0.0131)	0.0061 (0.0316)
PRE1	0.0486*** (0.0174)	-0.0404 (0.0299)	0.0401*** (0.0145)	-0.0272 (0.0266)
GAP	0.0058 (0.0181)	0.0353 (0.0318)	0.0006 (0.0129)	0.0312 (0.0281)
POST	-0.0195 (0.0127)	-0.0048 (0.0246)	-0.0142 (0.0102)	-0.0198 (0.0233)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	0.0428* (0.0221)	-0.0756* (0.0405)	0.0395** (0.0158)	-0.0585* (0.0355)
Drop: GAP – POST	0.0253 (0.0194)	0.0401 (0.0382)	0.0148 (0.0123)	0.0510 (0.0338)
Drop: PRE1 – POST	0.0681*** (0.0187)	-0.0355 (0.0358)	0.0543*** (0.0137)	-0.0075 (0.0314)
<i>Controls</i>				
Leverage	-0.0372* (0.0211)	-0.0286 (0.0194)	-0.0269 (0.0209)	-0.0270 (0.0191)
lnAssets	-0.0063 (0.0080)	-0.0041 (0.0062)	-0.0011 (0.0072)	-0.0036 (0.0061)
TobinsQ	-0.0034 (0.0029)	-0.0018 (0.0025)	-0.0022 (0.0027)	-0.0015 (0.0024)
ROA	0.0534* (0.0315)	0.0543* (0.0293)	0.0471 (0.0301)	0.0557* (0.0291)
Capex	0.0816 (0.0993)	0.1297 (0.0987)	0.1243 (0.1044)	0.1266 (0.0981)
DivDummy	-0.0065 (0.0100)	-0.0132* (0.0080)	-0.0093 (0.0093)	-0.0134* (0.0079)
sCFO	0.0049 (0.0084)	-0.0008 (0.0110)	0.0022 (0.0096)	-0.0005 (0.0109)
N	29,535	39,819	32,732	40,384
Firms	1,326	1,363	1,379	1,383

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed); SE clustered by firm.

Table 4: Table 5.5 — Formal Cash-Specificity (pooled Wald): Thesis (matched) vs. All Deals (stacked)

	Thesis (matched)			All deals (stacked)		
	UncRes	CashR(m)	CashR(f)	UncRes	CashR(m)	CashR(f)
Pre-announce qtr, Cash	0.0459** (0.0185)	0.0056** (0.0025)	0.0049*** (0.0019)	0.0447** (0.0180)	0.0061*** (0.0023)	0.0046*** (0.0017)
Pre-announce qtr, Stock	-0.0524 (0.0436)	-0.0008 (0.0066)	-0.0043 (0.0051)	-0.0609 (0.0385)	-0.0010 (0.0058)	-0.0042 (0.0046)
Cash – Stock (Wald)	0.0983** (0.0476)	0.0064 (0.0071)	0.0092* (0.0055)	0.1056** (0.0423)	0.0071 (0.0062)	0.0088* (0.0049)
<i>Controls</i>						
Leverage	-0.0411* (0.0230)	-0.0236*** (0.0056)	-0.0194*** (0.0043)	-0.0403* (0.0237)	-0.0211*** (0.0053)	-0.0193*** (0.0041)
InAssets	-0.0034 (0.0092)	-0.0033 (0.0021)	-0.0065*** (0.0011)	-0.0010 (0.0090)	-0.0037* (0.0021)	-0.0064*** (0.0011)
TobinsQ	-0.0025 (0.0031)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0012** (0.0005)	-0.0022 (0.0030)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0013** (0.0005)
ROA	0.0556 (0.0355)	0.0046 (0.0065)	0.0054 (0.0046)	0.0562 (0.0350)	0.0061 (0.0064)	0.0048 (0.0045)
Capex	0.0487 (0.1065)	-0.1437*** (0.0148)	-0.1095*** (0.0139)	0.1126 (0.1150)	-0.1404*** (0.0139)	-0.1101*** (0.0133)
DivDummy	-0.0068 (0.0109)	-0.0026* (0.0014)	-0.0015 (0.0010)	-0.0075 (0.0105)	-0.0024* (0.0014)	-0.0015 (0.0010)
sCFO	0.0040 (0.0088)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0009 (0.0006)	0.0044 (0.0090)	-0.0007 (0.0007)	0.0009 (0.0006)
CashRatio _{t-1} (partial adj.)	—	0.7778*** (0.0113)	0.7957*** (0.0073)	—	0.7825*** (0.0110)	0.7981*** (0.0070)
N	25,600	24,347	61,876	27,095	25,782	64,928
Firms	1,191	1,176	2,141	1,220	1,207	2,180

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed); SE clustered by firm.

Table 1: Round-Trip Event Study — All Payment Types

	(A) First deal, any type		(B) All deals stacked, any type	
	UncResCEO	CashRatio	UncResCEO	CashRatio
PRE2 ($t-2$, pre-trend)	0.0065 (0.0174)	0.0010 (0.0023)	0.0070 (0.0126)	0.0002 (0.0017)
PRE1 ($t-1$, pre-announce)	0.0533*** (0.0183)	0.0055** (0.0025)	0.0343** (0.0141)	0.0020 (0.0019)
GAP (announced, pre-close)	0.0160 (0.0181)	0.0049 (0.0031)	0.0067 (0.0125)	0.0042* (0.0023)
POST (completed)	-0.0237* (0.0130)	-0.0152*** (0.0023)	-0.0167 (0.0103)	-0.0156*** (0.0018)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	0.0374* (0.0226)	0.0007 (0.0036)	0.0276* (0.0150)	-0.0022 (0.0026)
Drop: GAP – POST	0.0396** (0.0198)	0.0200*** (0.0039)	0.0235** (0.0119)	0.0198*** (0.0025)
Drop: PRE1 – POST	0.0770*** (0.0198)	0.0207*** (0.0031)	0.0510*** (0.0132)	0.0176*** (0.0020)
<i>Controls</i>				
Leverage	-0.0541** (0.0226)	-0.0241*** (0.0058)	-0.0330 (0.0220)	-0.0231*** (0.0051)
lnAssets	-0.0027 (0.0095)	-0.0074*** (0.0021)	0.0040 (0.0081)	-0.0092*** (0.0018)
TobinsQ	-0.0047 (0.0032)	0.0014** (0.0006)	-0.0033 (0.0029)	0.0016*** (0.0006)
ROA	0.0574 (0.0382)	0.0079 (0.0070)	0.0515 (0.0346)	0.0068 (0.0064)
Capex	0.0793 (0.1161)	-0.1516*** (0.0150)	0.1485 (0.1175)	-0.1499*** (0.0139)
DivDummy	-0.0134 (0.0110)	-0.0018 (0.0015)	-0.0148 (0.0100)	-0.0017 (0.0015)
sCFO	0.0086** (0.0043)	-0.0011 (0.0007)	0.0059 (0.0062)	-0.0011 (0.0007)
CashRatio _{$t-1$} (partial adj.)	—	0.7555*** (0.0117)	—	0.7564*** (0.0106)
N	25,566	25,566	29,356	29,356
Firms	1,257	1,257	1,357	1,357

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed); SE clustered by firm.

Table 1: Materiality Grading: Pre-Announcement Run-Up by Relative Deal Size

	First deal		All deals (stacked)	
	All	Cash	All	Cash
<i>Event-window main effects β_{bin}</i>				
PRE2 ($t-2$)	0.0101 (0.0173)	0.0089 (0.0177)	0.0075 (0.0132)	0.0082 (0.0139)
PRE1 ($t-1$)	0.0502*** (0.0177)	0.0472*** (0.0178)	0.0390*** (0.0149)	0.0351** (0.0159)
GAP (announced)	0.0146 (0.0184)	0.0029 (0.0203)	0.0128 (0.0138)	0.0022 (0.0142)
POST (completed)	-0.0201 (0.0127)	-0.0192 (0.0129)	-0.0113 (0.0105)	-0.0138 (0.0106)
<i>Materiality interactions $\delta_{\text{bin}} = \text{bin} \times \ln(\text{Mag})$</i>				
PRE2 ($t-2$) $\times \ln\text{Mag}$	0.0107 (0.0114)	0.0033 (0.0112)	0.0021 (0.0074)	-0.0018 (0.0084)
PRE1 ($t-1$) $\times \ln\text{Mag}$	-0.0006 (0.0120)	0.0061 (0.0118)	0.0039 (0.0083)	0.0090 (0.0092)
GAP (announced) $\times \ln\text{Mag}$	0.0044 (0.0110)	0.0020 (0.0107)	0.0037 (0.0069)	0.0059 (0.0067)
POST (completed) $\times \ln\text{Mag}$	-0.0087 (0.0083)	-0.0038 (0.0083)	0.0001 (0.0051)	0.0011 (0.0056)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	-0.0050 (0.0140)	0.0041 (0.0139)	0.0002 (0.0095)	0.0031 (0.0096)
Firm FE / Year-Qtr FE / Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N (firm-quarters)	26,800	29,459	31,589	33,426
Firms	1,245	1,310	1,376	1,389

Notes: Standard errors clustered by firm in parentheses. * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed).

Table 1: Logit A — CEO Q&A Uncertainty Predicts a Deal Next Quarter

	Deal next quarter	
	= 1 if a deal (any payment type) is announced in the next quarter	
	(1) LPM	(2) Logit
UncResCEO	0.0086 *** (0.0026)	0.3233 *** (0.0967)
Leverage	-0.0191 *** (0.0057)	-0.7816 *** (0.2552)
lnAssets	0.0080 *** (0.0015)	0.2772 *** (0.0435)
TobinsQ	0.0025 *** (0.0009)	0.0703 *** (0.0249)
ROA	0.0114 (0.0086)	0.6546 (0.4291)
Capex	-0.1467 *** (0.0223)	-8.1674 *** (1.6401)
DivDummy	-0.0105 *** (0.0026)	-0.3728 *** (0.0926)
sCFO	0.0000 (0.0029)	-0.0074 (0.1257)
<i>N</i>	40,004	40,004
Firms	1,422	1,422
<i>R</i> ² / Pseudo- <i>R</i> ²	0.006	0.026

Notes: Col. (1) is a linear probability model; col. (2) a logit (raw log-odds coefficients). UncResCEO is the only CEO-speech regressor; all controls shown. No fixed effects; standard errors (parentheses) clustered by firm; significant coefficients in **bold**. * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed).

Table 2: Logit B — Among Deals, CEO Q&A Uncertainty Predicts Cash vs. Stock

	Cash deal	
	= 1 if cash-financed, 0 if stock-financed (deals only)	
	(1) LPM	(2) Logit
UncResCEO	0.0613** (0.0283)	0.7478** (0.3399)
Leverage	-0.0397 (0.0549)	-0.5117 (0.5594)
lnAssets	0.0033 (0.0068)	0.0372 (0.0794)
TobinsQ	-0.0424*** (0.0135)	-0.3002*** (0.0932)
ROA	0.8612*** (0.1895)	5.5995*** (1.4060)
Capex	-1.0620*** (0.3251)	-7.2199*** (2.2851)
DivDummy	-0.0023 (0.0210)	0.0135 (0.2375)
sCFO	-0.0327 (0.0540)	-0.2268 (0.3054)
<i>N</i>	1,105	1,105
Firms	563	563
R^2 / Pseudo- R^2	0.075	0.078

Notes: Col. (1) is a linear probability model; col. (2) a logit (raw log-odds coefficients). UncResCEO is the only CEO-speech regressor; all controls shown. No fixed effects; standard errors (parentheses) clustered by firm; significant coefficients in **bold**. * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ (two-tailed).